1. **Hesitations:** you should not bother too much about your hesitations. They generally enable the listener to follow you.

2. **Intonation**: very often falling at the end of sentences (which helps the listener understand that you have finished your sentence) / rising in yes-no questions.

3. **Pauses:** a longer pause may indicate to your listener that you're going to change subjects, end a part and begin a new one, introduce a new idea into your commentary (very short pauses aim at separating breath units).

4. **Breath units / chunking**: you can pause as much as you want, but there are words that have to be linked together and spoken together.

5. **Liaisons:** some words are to be attached for fluidity eg: *He was attacked* → / hiː wɒz əˈtækt /

6. **Organisation** of your speech : contrary to written material, which falls back mostly on punctuation and paragraphs, oral speech falls back on signposting language which enables the listener to follow you.

Words and expressions which enable you to:

✓ *think and collect your thoughts / take your time / breathe (GAP FILLERS)*

Well… / Right… / So… / Okay… / Er… / Let me think …

✓ *come back on your main idea*

…Anyway…

✓ *organise your presentation*

Firstly…, Secondly…
I'm going to talk first about…Then I shall say a few words about…
Let's move on to…/ …I will come back to that later …/ …So now I'd like to say a few words about…./ At this point, it is necessary to say that…
To conclude I'd like to say…/ …finally it is important to say that …

✓ *add information*

Then, you have…/ Another thing too is …/ Besides…/ In addition… / Furthermore…/ What's more

✓ *give examples*

For instance… / For example… / you've got lots of examples such as this one in … / It enables us to enumerate all kinds of problems such as poverty, pollution, etc… /

✓ *express your opinion*

I think that… / I suppose that… / What I think is important to mention is that… / To my mind…